```
phoneNumbers.darth
# '555-5552'
```

Calling Hal to ask him if he's feeling better is similar:

```
phoneNumbers.hal9000
# 'disconnected'
```

This dot notation doesn't always work, though. Some properties don't play nice.

Quoted property names and square brackets

How do you get the phone number for T-800? This doesn't work:

```
phoneNumbers.T-800
# NaN
```

Why doesn't it work? Look at it again:

```
phoneNumbers.T - 800
```

You can't use the minus symbol to access a property name because minus means subtraction. Instead, to use a property that's not a valid name, you put quotes around the property and *square brackets* around the quotes:

```
phoneNumbers['T-800']
# '555-5555'
```

Although properties that aren't valid names can't be accessed with dot notation, any property can be accessed using square brackets:

```
phoneNumbers['freddy']
# '555-5554'
```

In general, dot notation is easier to read, so it should be preferred for accessing any properties that don't contain special characters; that is, unless the property name is in a variable.

Property names from variables